



2026

NEET

MBBS SEATS IN INDIA

A Complete Overview of the Official Seat Matrix, Trends and Opportunities for Aspirants

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1. Introduction

NEET UG is India's unified entrance test for undergraduate medical programs, covering MBBS, BDS and related health-science courses. It is conducted by the National Testing Agency and offers a single, standardized way of ranking every applicant across the country.

Before NEET UG came into effect, individual states and institutions ran their own separate entrance exams. Bringing everyone onto one common platform made the process far simpler to follow and gave students from every region a fair shot at competing on merit.

At the heart of the admission process lies the seat matrix — the full count of MBBS seats on offer across the country's medical colleges. The 2026–27 seat matrix breaks this down by institution type, quota category and state, and is drawn directly from the seat matrix published by the National Medical Commission (NMC), the body responsible for regulating medical education and approving how many seats each college may offer.

Ahead of every counselling round, the Medical Counselling Committee publishes the All India Quota matrix, covering the 15% of seats open to candidates nationwide — spread across government colleges, central institutions and other participating bodies. Students rely heavily on this list when building their preference order during counselling.

The remaining 85% of seats fall under individual State Quotas, run separately by each state's own counselling authority and generally reserved for candidates who meet that state's domicile criteria. Between them, the All India Quota and the State Quota make up the entire seat-allocation system for MBBS admissions in the country.

Clearing NEET is only the starting point — candidates then have to work through the counselling process itself, where seats are handed out according to rank, category, choice of college and what is actually available. AIQ counselling is handled centrally by the MCC, while each state runs its own parallel process, so staying on top of multiple counselling schedules is part of the job for every aspirant.

Far from being just a set of numbers, the seat matrix is a planning tool: it lets candidates gauge the level of competition realistically and plan their counselling choices with more confidence. With the number of applicants running into the lakhs against a comparatively limited pool of seats, reading the matrix correctly matters almost as much as the exam score itself.

In short, NEET UG opens the door to medical education in India, and the seat matrix is the map that shows candidates how to get from a rank to an actual seat. Understanding both well is what allows aspirants to approach the process calmly and strategically.

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2. Total MBBS Seats in India

Looking at the total count of MBBS seats — split between government and private colleges, and tracked over successive years — gives a clear sense of how much India's medical education system has grown and how competition has shifted over time.

2.1 Total Seats Overview

The overall seat count is the starting point for any NEET preparation plan. Per the National Medical Commission's finalised Seat Matrix for AY 2026–27 (issued 14-07-2026), India offers a combined total of 1,36,939 MBBS seats across 823 medical colleges — continuing a steady expansion of medical education capacity. This growth supports the government's broader aim of improving the doctor-to-population ratio and widening access to healthcare nationwide.

Note: this seat matrix, and every figure in this report, excludes seats at Institutes of National Importance (INIs) such as AIIMS and JIPMER, which are governed under a separate framework — see Section 3.1.

MBBS Seat Distribution in India (2026–27, excluding INIs)

Category	No. of Colleges	Total Seats
Government Colleges	441	63,296
Private Colleges	382	73,643
Total MBBS Seats	823	1,36,939

Key Insights

- **Private colleges now hold the larger share:** private colleges account for 53.8% of all seats against 46.2% for government colleges — a gap that has widened compared with earlier years, when the split was close to even.
- **Government colleges still form the largest single block of institutions:** with 441 government colleges against 382 private ones, though private colleges now contribute more seats per college on average.
- **INI seats are tracked separately:** AIIMS, JIPMER and other Institutes of National Importance are not part of this NMC seat matrix and are counted separately (see Section 3.1).

2.2 Year-wise Growth of MBBS Seats

India's medical education capacity has expanded steadily as part of a broader push to build up the healthcare workforce. This growth has come both from new medical colleges opening and from existing institutions increasing their intake across different parts of the country.

The 2026–27 cycle saw a sharp jump in seat numbers compared with the previous few years, driven largely by intake-capacity increases at existing colleges together with a batch of newly approved medical colleges.

MBBS Seat Growth Trend

Year	Medical Colleges	Total MBBS Seats	Increase in Seats
2022	679	98,682	—

Year	Medical Colleges	Total MBBS Seats	Increase in Seats
2023	706	1,08,940	+10,258
2024	731	1,17,750	+8,810
2025	808	1,23,700	+5,950
2026	823	1,36,939	+13,239

2022–2025 figures as previously compiled from NMC updates; 2026 figure per the finalised NMC Seat Matrix dated 14-07-2026, subject to revision by the Appeal Committee.

Key Insights

- **2026 saw the single largest seat addition in the period:** seats rose by 13,239 over 2025 — well above the additions seen in any of the preceding three years, reversing the earlier slowdown.
- **Most of the growth came from existing colleges, not just new ones:** of the 9,911 additional seats approved nationally, 2,400 seats come from 25 newly established colleges (7 government, 18 private); the remaining seats come from intake-capacity increases at already-running colleges.
- **Growth over the full period remains strong:** seats have grown from 98,682 in 2022 to 1,36,939 in 2026 — an increase of about 39% over four years.

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3. Seat Distribution Framework

How MBBS seats are distributed touches on several layers — government versus private colleges, premier national institutions, the quota system, and reservation categories such as SC, ST, OBC, EWS and PwD. Together these layers shape how much competition a given candidate actually faces.

3.1 Institutes of National Importance (AIIMS, JIPMER)

AIIMS, JIPMER and similar Institutes of National Importance (INIs) sit outside the NMC seat matrix covered in this report — they are administered under their own governing Acts rather than through NMC's college-approval process, which is why the National Medical Commission's Seat Matrix for AY 2026–27 explicitly excludes them.

The AIIMS institutions are run centrally as institutes of national importance, known for consistent infrastructure and comparatively low fees. Admission runs entirely through NEET under the All India Quota, which makes these seats intensely competitive and realistically within reach only for candidates near the top of the rank list. JIPMER, based in Puducherry and Karaikal, is likewise centrally administered and fills its MBBS seats through NEET at the national level, though its intake is smaller.

Deemed universities, by contrast, are included within the NMC seat matrix and this report's totals — they run independently and fill all their seats through centralized counselling, usually charging considerably more but offering a larger number of seats overall than AIIMS or JIPMER.

Seat Allocation Structure — INIs vs Deemed Universities

Institution Type	Included in NMC Matrix	Admission Mode	Key Characteristic
AIIMS	No — separate framework	NEET (AIQ)	Highly prestigious, low fees
JIPMER	No — separate framework	NEET (AIQ)	Central institute, limited seats
Deemed Universities	Yes	NEET (central counselling)	High fees, greater seat availability

Key Insights

- **AIIMS and JIPMER sit outside this seat matrix:** they are fiercely competitive national institutes filled on all-India merit, but their seats are not counted in the totals reported in Sections 2, 4 and 5 of this report.
- **Deemed universities widen access, but at a cost:** their seats are filled entirely through centralized counselling and are included in the NMC matrix, improving the odds of admission but requiring a much larger financial commitment.

3.2 All India Quota vs State Quota

How seats are split between the All India Quota and the State Quota is a defining feature of NEET counselling, shaping which colleges a candidate can realistically aim for. The AIQ opens doors nationally, while the State Quota favours candidates based on domicile, creating a system that balances national-level competition against more localized access.

The All India Quota covers a smaller slice of the total seats but lets candidates apply to colleges anywhere in the country through centralized counselling run by the Medical Counselling Committee. The State Quota, by contrast, accounts for the bulk of seats and is managed separately by each state, generally limiting eligibility to local candidates while often involving comparatively less competition in particular states.

AIQ vs State Quota Comparison

Factor	AIQ (15%)	State Quota (85%)
Seat Share	15%	85%
Eligibility	Open to all-India candidates	State domicile required
Competition Level	Very high	Moderate (varies by state)
Counselling Body	Central (MCC)	State authorities
College Options	Pan-India	Within the state

Key Insights

- **The State Quota carries most of the seat allocation (about 85%):** state-level counselling remains the main route into MBBS for the majority of candidates.
- **AIQ opens up more choice but comes with tougher competition:** it gives access to colleges across the country, but draws top-ranking candidates from every state, pushing competition higher.
- **The State Quota can work in a candidate's favour:** domicile-based eligibility often means comparatively lower cut-offs than AIQ, depending on the state in question.

3.3 Category-wise Reservation (SC / ST / OBC / EWS / PwD)

Reservation policy plays a central role in making MBBS admissions more equitable across social and economic groups. Within the NEET counselling framework, seats are set aside for defined categories, mainly across both the All India Quota and State Quota systems, in order to keep the process inclusive while remaining structured.

The reservation framework splits into vertical categories — SC, ST, OBC and EWS — and a horizontal category, PwD, which applies across all the vertical groups rather than as a separate quota. This structure has a real bearing on cut-offs, seat availability and how competitive admissions are for candidates from different backgrounds.

Category-wise Reservation Structure (AIQ)

Category	Reservation %
SC (Scheduled Castes)	15%
ST (Scheduled Tribes)	7.5%
OBC (Non-Creamy Layer)	27%
EWS (Economically Weaker Section)	10%
PwD (Persons with Disabilities)	5% (horizontal)

Key Insights

- **Reserved categories account for a sizeable share of seats (roughly 60%):** category status plays a major role in shaping a candidate's actual admission chances.
- **OBC carries the largest reservation among the categories:** at 27%, OBC candidates receive the biggest allocation within the reservation framework.
- **PwD reservation cuts across every category:** unlike the other groups, it is applied horizontally within each category rather than as its own standalone quota.

4. State-wise MBBS Seat Matrix

Breaking the seat matrix down by state shows how unevenly medical education opportunities are spread across the country, shaped by factors like population size, healthcare infrastructure, and how many medical colleges a state has. As a result, seat counts vary widely from one state to the next, which in turn affects how tough competition is and how realistic admission chances are for aspirants in each region.

States with more medical colleges naturally offer more seats, improving chances under both the AIQ and the State Quota. States with fewer institutions have a smaller pool of seats, which usually means tougher competition within their own state quota. Factoring in this variation is an important part of planning a counselling strategy.

State-wise MBBS Seats (2026–27)

S.No.	State / UT	Total Seats
1	Andaman & Nicobar Islands	114
2	Andhra Pradesh	7,465
3	Arunachal Pradesh	100
4	Assam	1,875
5	Bihar	4,160
6	Chandigarh	200
7	Chhattisgarh	2,925
8	Dadra & Nagar Haveli	177
9	Delhi	1,415
10	Goa	250
11	Gujarat	7,750
12	Haryana	2,960
13	Himachal Pradesh	871
14	Jammu & Kashmir	1,675
15	Jharkhand	1,500
16	Karnataka	15,395
17	Kerala	5,704
18	Madhya Pradesh	6,020
19	Maharashtra	13,099
20	Manipur	550
21	Meghalaya	250
22	Mizoram	100
23	Nagaland	100
24	Odisha	2,950

S.No.	State / UT	Total Seats
25	Puducherry	1,780
26	Punjab	1,850
27	Rajasthan	8,080
28	Sikkim	200
29	Tamil Nadu	13,999
30	Telangana	10,250
31	Tripura	500
32	Uttar Pradesh	14,000
33	Uttarakhand	1,475
34	West Bengal	7,200
	Total	1,36,939

Key Insights

- **The top five states account for close to half of all seats:** Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Telangana together make up about 48.7% of the national total, making them the biggest hubs for medical education.
- **Southern states hold the single largest regional share:** Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala together account for about 38.6% of seats, backed by strong private and government medical infrastructure.
- **Mid-sized states offer a fair middle ground:** Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal together provide about 21.2% of seats, making them worthwhile options for candidates with mid-range NEET ranks.
- **Smaller states and union territories contribute only a little:** the North-Eastern states and smaller UTs each account for under 1% of the national total, meaning fewer overall opportunities but sometimes easier competition within their state quota.

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5. Government vs Private Colleges

Comparing government and private medical colleges gives a clearer picture of how MBBS seats are actually distributed in India — differences in cost, competition and accessibility all factor into how aspirants should plan their NEET rank strategy, budget and overall counselling approach.

5.1 Government Medical Colleges (MBBS Seats 2026–27)

Government medical colleges are the backbone of MBBS education in the country, accounting for a large share of total seats filled through NEET. They tend to be the preferred choice thanks to low fees, a consistent academic structure, and solid hands-on clinical training through government hospitals — all of which support wide, affordable access to quality medical education.

How many government MBBS seats a state has depends on things like its investment in public healthcare and the number of medical colleges it runs. States with more government institutions naturally offer better chances under both the AIQ and their own state quota — though because of their affordability and reputation, government colleges remain the most fiercely contested segment of NEET admissions.

Government MBBS Seats — State-wise (2026–27)

S.No.	State / UT	Total Seats
1	Maharashtra	6,000
2	Uttar Pradesh	5,700
3	Tamil Nadu	5,349
4	Rajasthan	4,480
5	Karnataka	4,400
6	Telangana	4,400
7	West Bengal	4,350
8	Gujarat	4,250
9	Andhra Pradesh	3,515
10	Madhya Pradesh	3,020
11	Assam	1,875
12	Kerala	1,855
13	Odisha	1,850
14	Chhattisgarh	1,725
15	Bihar	1,710
16	Jammu & Kashmir	1,525
17	Delhi	1,165
18	Haryana	1,060
19	Punjab	900
20	Jharkhand	800

S.No.	State / UT	Total Seats
21	Himachal Pradesh	721
22	Uttarakhand	625
23	Manipur	400
24	Goa	250
25	Chandigarh	200
26	Tripura	200
27	Puducherry	180
28	Dadra & Nagar Haveli	177
29	Andaman & Nicobar Islands	114
30	Arunachal Pradesh	100
31	Meghalaya	100
32	Mizoram	100
33	Nagaland	100
34	Sikkim	100
	Total	63,296

Key Insights

- **A handful of states dominate government seat allocation:** Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan, Karnataka together provide about 41.0% of all government MBBS seats, making them key states for admission opportunities.
- **The south and west together lead the pack:** Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana, Maharashtra and Gujarat collectively hold about 38.5% of government seats, reflecting their strong public healthcare systems.
- **Smaller states add up to very little:** the North-Eastern states and smaller UTs have very few government seats each, meaning limited options but occasionally lower competition within their state quotas.

5.2 Private Medical Colleges (MBBS Seats 2026–27)

Private medical colleges make up a significant part of India's MBBS seat matrix, contributing just over half of all seats. They play an important role in widening access to medical education, especially for candidates who don't manage to secure a government seat given the level of competition. Spread across many states, private colleges add flexibility and extra options during counselling.

Private medical colleges are especially concentrated in states with well-developed educational infrastructure, particularly in the south and west. They tend to offer more seats and somewhat lower cut-offs than government colleges, but come with substantially higher tuition — making financial planning an important part of the decision for anyone considering a private MBBS seat.

Private MBBS Seats — State-wise (2026–27)

S.No.	State / UT	Total Seats
1	Karnataka	10,995
2	Tamil Nadu	8,650
3	Uttar Pradesh	8,300
4	Maharashtra	7,099
5	Telangana	5,850
6	Andhra Pradesh	3,950
7	Kerala	3,849
8	Rajasthan	3,600
9	Gujarat	3,500
10	Madhya Pradesh	3,000
11	West Bengal	2,850
12	Bihar	2,450
13	Haryana	1,900
14	Puducherry	1,600
15	Chhattisgarh	1,200
16	Odisha	1,100
17	Punjab	950
18	Uttarakhand	850
19	Jharkhand	700
20	Tripura	300
21	Delhi	250
22	Himachal Pradesh	150
23	Jammu & Kashmir	150
24	Manipur	150
25	Meghalaya	150
26	Sikkim	100
	Total	73,643

Key Insights

- **The top five states hold more than half of all private seats:** Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Telangana together account for about 55.5% of the country's private MBBS seats.
- **Southern states lead by a wide margin:** Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala together form about 45.2% of private medical education capacity.

- **Private colleges widen access overall:** with more seats on offer and comparatively lower cut-offs in many states, private institutions give mid- and lower-rank NEET candidates a real shot at admission, albeit at a higher financial cost.

5.3 Government vs Private Seat Matrix Comparison

Setting government and private colleges side by side helps clarify the overall structure of MBBS seat distribution in India. The two sectors now contribute noticeably different numbers of seats, and they differ sharply in cost, competition, accessibility and general admission dynamics — differences that matter a great deal when building a counselling strategy.

Government colleges combine low cost with intense competition, which keeps them the most in-demand option. Private colleges, on the other hand, offer more seats and generally lower cut-offs, but at a much higher price. Between the two, they form a dual system that balances merit-based selection against broader access to medical education.

Government vs Private MBBS Seats Comparison (2026–27)

Factor	Government Colleges	Private Colleges
Total Seats	63,296	73,643
Seat Share	46.2%	53.8%
Fees (approx.)	Low (heavily subsidized)	High (₹10–25 lakh/year)
Competition Level	Very high	Moderate
Cut-off Trend	High	Relatively lower
Accessibility	Limited	Higher
Clinical Exposure	Extensive	Varies by college
Preferred By	Top rankers	Mid to lower rankers

Key Insights

- **Private colleges now hold a clear seat-share lead:** at 53.8% versus 46.2% for government colleges, the gap has widened from the roughly even split seen in earlier years.
- **Government colleges remain intensely competitive:** low fees paired with strong clinical training draw the largest number of applicants, pushing cut-offs to the top of the scale.
- **Private colleges add extra room for admission:** with a larger seat share and generally lower cut-offs, they offer a workable route for students who miss out on a government seat.

5.4 AIIMS MBBS Seats (Reference — Not Part of the NMC Matrix)

AIIMS represents the most prestigious tier within India's medical education landscape — recognized for high academic standards, strong infrastructure and comparatively affordable fees, which makes it the top choice for high-ranking NEET candidates. As noted in Section 3.1, AIIMS seats are not part of the NMC Seat Matrix figures used elsewhere in this report; they are administered separately as Institutes of National Importance and are shown here for reference only.

AIIMS campuses are spread across several states, improving regional access to quality medical education. Even with this expansion, the total number of seats stays limited, which keeps competition extremely high — admission, especially to flagship campuses such as AIIMS New Delhi, typically demands a very high percentile rank.

AIIMS MBBS Seats — State-wise (Reference, previously published figures)

S.No.	State / UT	Name of College	Total Seats
1	Andhra Pradesh	AIIMS Mangalagiri, Vijayawada	125
2	Assam	AIIMS Guwahati	100
3	Bihar	AIIMS Patna	125
4	Chhattisgarh	AIIMS Raipur	125
5	Delhi	AIIMS New Delhi	132
6	Gujarat	AIIMS Rajkot	75
7	Himachal Pradesh	AIIMS Bilaspur	100
8	Jammu & Kashmir	AIIMS Vijaypur	100
9	Jharkhand	AIIMS Deoghar	125
10	Madhya Pradesh	AIIMS Bhopal	125
11	Maharashtra	AIIMS Nagpur	125
12	Odisha	AIIMS Bhubaneswar	125
13	Punjab	AIIMS Bathinda	100
14	Rajasthan	AIIMS Jodhpur	150
15	Tamil Nadu	AIIMS Madurai	50
16	Telangana	AIIMS Bibinagar	100
17	Uttar Pradesh	AIIMS Gorakhpur	125
18	Uttar Pradesh	AIIMS Rae Bareli	100
19	Uttarakhand	AIIMS Rishikesh	125
20	West Bengal	AIIMS Kalyani	125
		Total	2,267

Figures as previously compiled; not covered by the 14-07-2026 NMC notice, which excludes INIs. Confirm current AIIMS intake directly with individual AIIMS campuses or the MCC before relying on these for counselling decisions.

Key Insights

- **AIIMS seats sit entirely outside the NMC matrix:** they are governed and counted separately from the government/private totals discussed in Sections 2, 4 and 5.
- **Admission is extremely competitive, requiring top ranks:** flagship campuses such as Delhi and Jodhpur in particular demand exceptionally high NEET ranks.
- **The network has a genuinely national footprint:** AIIMS campuses are spread across many states, improving access to high-quality medical education in different regions.

6. Conclusion

The finalised 2026–27 MBBS seat matrix points to a medical education system in India that keeps growing while becoming more structured. With 1,36,939 MBBS seats spread across 823 government and private institutions (excluding INIs), the country continues to build out its healthcare workforce while making medical education more accessible to aspiring students.

One notable feature of the 2026–27 matrix is the widening gap between the two sectors: private colleges now account for 53.8% of all seats against 46.2% for government colleges, a shift from the near-even split seen in earlier years. Government colleges remain the most in-demand thanks to their affordability and strong clinical training, but their comparatively smaller numbers translate into fierce competition and high cut-offs. Private colleges, meanwhile, play a growing role in expanding opportunities — particularly for candidates with mid-to-lower ranks — though at a considerably higher financial cost.

The quota system underpins the entire admission process. The State Quota, covering 85% of seats, is the main route for most candidates, especially those who benefit from domicile-based eligibility. The All India Quota, at 15%, offers wider access across institutions but comes with much stiffer competition, drawing top-ranking candidates from across the country. On top of this, the reservation framework — covering SC, ST, OBC, EWS and PwD candidates — keeps the system inclusive, with close to 60% of seats reserved, which has a real influence on admission dynamics and cut-off trends.

Seat distribution across the country is far from even, with Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra and Telangana together accounting for close to half of all seats. This creates real geographic disparities in opportunity, making a state-specific strategy an important part of counselling.

Elite institutions such as AIIMS and JIPMER, despite having relatively few seats, set the benchmark for academic excellence and remain the ultimate goal for top-performing NEET candidates — though, as this report notes, their seats fall outside the NMC seat matrix entirely and are governed separately. Deemed universities, meanwhile, widen access by offering a larger number of seats through centralized counselling within the same matrix, albeit at higher fees.

Taken together, the 2026–27 seat matrix reflects a dual system built on both merit and accessibility, where success depends not just on exam performance but also on a well-planned counselling strategy. Understanding seat distribution, the quota system, state-level dynamics and the financial trade-offs involved is essential for making the most of one's admission chances. As seat numbers keep growing — and 2026–27 saw the sharpest single-year jump in recent years — aspirants have broader opportunities ahead of them, but still need to navigate the process strategically to secure a place in India's highly competitive medical education landscape.

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